

LEVEL 1 • TERM 1 • LESSON 7 • FOR PARENTS

7 Take Away, Count Up

WHAT WE DID

We learned two ways to find the answer to a subtraction. To find how many are left, we take away the tens, then the ones. To find how far apart two numbers are (the difference), we count up the gap. This term goes beyond the school Primary 1 syllabus on purpose, with bars and squares to help. Each week we suggest Home Practice (about 15 minutes); pages 3 to 5 and online practice are optional.

> **The difference is a gap. Take away to see what is left. Count up to see the gap.**

TRY AT HOME (5 MINUTES)

1. Two piles: make two piles of small things, such as 38 and 62 coins or buttons. Ask: how many more in the big pile? Count up the gap together: hop to the next ten, jump by tens, hop to the number.
2. Take it away: say a number up to 80 and a number to take away, such as 68 take away 25 (not 62 take away 28: the ones must fit). Take the tens first, then the ones. Then check by adding back.
3. Spot it: look at two page numbers, two house numbers or two ages. Ask: how far from one to the other? Which way is quicker, taking away or counting up?

When your child is stuck

Let your child use real things or draw bars and squares, and wait 10 seconds before helping. Asking 'What is the next ten?' works better than giving the answer. Please do not teach the column method yet. If your child ticked I am still stuck on the look-back page, photograph that page and send it to the business WhatsApp, +65 9880 5962, after class. Photos are kept for 90 days after the program ends, then deleted.

Words we used

- take away: find what is left (57 - 24 = 33)
- count up: find the gap from the smaller number to the greater number
- difference: the gap between two numbers
- check: add the answer back to the number taken away

Good questions

- How do you know?
- Which is quicker here, taking away or counting up? Why?
- How can you check your answer?

Have ready for next lesson

- About 30 small things of one kind (buttons, pasta, paper clips); keep your bars and squares from the first lesson
- Two plates or bowls, marked LEFT and RIGHT
- The printed Lesson 8 workbook, a pencil and spare paper

Next lesson

Lesson 8: Balance and Swap. The recording has the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted; your child may mute and keep the camera off. The recording link is private to your family: please do not share it. Missed a lesson? Every lesson is recorded; your tutor will share a private link with enrolled families.